

Create a Process Trigger

SAP Build Process Automation — ABAP Environment Workflow Integration

Beginner

15 min

Customer/Partner License

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Overview & Objectives

A business process in **SAP Build Process Automation (SBPA)** is started by defining a *trigger*—an event or mechanism that instructs your tenant to initiate a process instance.

Process triggers can be of three primary types:

- **Form Trigger:** Initiates a process via an interactive user request form.
- **API Trigger:** Initiates a process via an external REST API call from system environments like S/4HANA or SAP BTP ABAP Environment.
- **Event Trigger:** Listens to back-end business events emitted from connected external systems and automatically starts processes or automations.

In this tutorial, you will configure an **API Trigger** with process inputs so that external systems (such as the SAP BTP ABAP Environment) can programmatically start workflow process instances.

Prerequisites

You have already created a Business Process Project (e.g., RAP110_Travel_Workflow) and a Business Process (e.g., Travel Approval Processing) in SAP Build Process Automation.

Step 1: Create the Data Type for the API Trigger

A **Data Type** defines the structured data payload that will be passed as input/output parameters for automations or processes. You can define fields manually or import an Excel file.

1. In your SAP Build Process Automation project, choose **Create > Data Type**.
2. Set the Name to `Travel Context` and click **Create**.
3. Click **New Field** to add input parameters to the `Travel Context` data type.
4. Define all required fields as listed in the table below:

Field Name	Type	Description
<code>Travel id</code>	String	Unique identifier for the travel record

Field Name	Type	Description
Agency Name	String	Name of the travel agency handling booking
Booking fee	String	Booking fee amount
Currency Code	String	Currency code (e.g. EUR, USD)
Customer Name	String	Name of the customer / employee
Total price	String	Total cost for the travel request

Important Naming Note

Spelling, capitalization, and spaces are critical because the external API call payload must match these exact field names. In this tutorial, standard Title Case without underscores (e.g. Travel id, Agency Name) is used.

5. Click **Save** to complete the data type creation.

Step 2: Create an API Trigger for the Process

Next, attach an API trigger to the business process so external systems can send a request to start the workflow.

1. Open the process named `Travel Approval Processing`.
2. Click **Add API trigger** on the canvas header.
3. Select **Call an API** (enables invocation from S/4HANA or SAP BTP ABAP Environment).
4. Provide the trigger configuration details:
 - **Name:** `Travel Approval Trigger`
 - **Description:** `Travel Approval Trigger`
 - *Identifier:* Auto-filled by the system.
5. Click **Create** to finalize the API trigger.

Step 3: Configure Process Inputs

Now, map the created `Travel Context` data type as an input variable for the business process.

1. Open **Process Details** by clicking anywhere on the process canvas background.
2. Navigate to the **Variables** tab on the side panel and choose **Configure** (under Process Inputs).
3. In the *Configure Process Inputs* window, click **Add Input**.

4. Fill in the parameter details:

Field Name	Identifier	Data Type
Travel Context	Travel Context	Select Travel Context (created in Step 1)

5. Click **Apply**. The new input field is now active in Process Details.

6. Click **Save** on the top bar to save all project changes.

Runtime & Deployment Behavior

Once saved, API triggers can be viewed under the **Triggers** tab on the Overview page.

- **Deactivate:** Keeps the trigger in design-time but prevents consumption at runtime.
- **Delete:** Permanently removes the trigger from design-time (deployed instances keep runtime triggers until redeployed).
- **Deployment:** Any changes take effect only after the project is *released* and *deployed*.

Test Yourself / Quick Quiz

Q: What types of triggers can be used to initiate a workflow process in SAP Build Process Automation?

- ☒ **Form Trigger** (User entry forms)
- ☒ **Event Trigger** (System events)
- ☒ **API Trigger** (External REST call from BTP ABAP / S/4HANA)

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